



CASE STUDY · PRODUCT MARKETING

Turning Products Beta Into a Strategic Growth Lever

How a structured beta program transformed product launches at Trustpilot, reducing risk, improving adoption, and elevating customer trust across the GTM lifecycle.

01 The Problem

Without a structured approach, beta launches were unpredictable and hard to learn from.



No Structured Program

Beta was ad hoc, inconsistent, and difficult to scale across product lines.



Reactive Feedback

Insights arrived too late, often post-launch, limiting their impact on product decisions.



Limited Pre-Launch Validation

Features shipped without rigorous customer signal, increasing release risk.



Adoption & Churn Risk

Low early engagement meant weak product-market fit signals and elevated churn exposure.

02 The Goal

Build a beta program that creates measurable value before, during, and after launch.

1

Build a Scalable Beta Program

Create a repeatable, structured system that could grow with Trustpilot's product portfolio.

2

Drive Actionable Insights

Capture high-quality, timely feedback that product teams could actually use to make decisions.

3

Improve Adoption Pre-GA

Use beta as a conversion engine, turning engaged testers into committed users at GA.

4

Support Churn Reduction

Tie early engagement signals back to long-term retention, making beta a GTM lever for growth.

03

My Role

End-to-end ownership across strategy, systems, alignment, and operationalization.

Strategy



Owned End-to-End Beta Strategy

Designed and led the full program, from goal setting and recruiting criteria to comms calendars and feedback analysis.

Systems



Built Recruitment + Comms Systems

Created scalable pipelines for user recruitment and structured outreach that could be templated and reused.

Alignment



Aligned Product, CS & Marketing

Served as the connective tissue between functions, translating customer insight into language each team could act on.

Ops



Operationalized Feedback into Roadmap

Closed the loop by converting raw beta feedback into structured inputs, prioritized and delivered to product leadership.

04 Approach

Four strategic pillars that shaped the beta program from the ground up.

01 Target High-Fit Users

Prioritized customer segments most likely to activate, engage, and generate signal — not just those who expressed interest.

02 Drive Engagement Through Positioning

Framed beta as an exclusive, co-creation opportunity. Made participants feel invested, not just observed.

03 Build Structured Feedback Loops

Moved beyond ad hoc surveys to systematic check-ins, in-product prompts, and regular synthesis cycles.

04 Turn Insights into Product Decisions

Created clear handoff workflows so feedback didn't sit in a spreadsheet, it landed on the roadmap.

05

Execution

Translating strategy into a repeatable operating model.

1

Segmented High-Value Users

Used behavioral and firmographic data to identify beta candidates with the highest likelihood of meaningful engagement and churn risk signal.

2

Activated Lifecycle, In-Product & CS Channels

Recruited through multiple touchpoints, lifecycle emails, in-app prompts, and CS team relationships, ensuring quality over volume.

3

Positioned Beta as Exclusive

Created invite-only framing and early-access messaging that elevated participation. Beta became a status, not a checkbox.

4

Created a Repeatable Feedback System

Documented intake, synthesis, and delivery workflows so every future beta cycle could launch faster and produce sharper insights.

06 Results

The program delivered across every dimension it was designed to improve.



Stronger Product Validation

Features entered GA with higher confidence, backed by real customer signal gathered during structured beta cycles.



Higher Beta Adoption

Exclusive positioning and targeted recruitment drove measurably stronger engagement from beta participants.



More Actionable Insights

Structured feedback loops replaced ad hoc input with synthesized, prioritized insight that product teams could act on.

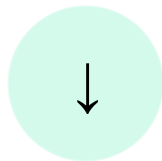


Improved Cross-Functional Alignment

Product, CS, and Marketing moved in sync — shared beta data replaced siloed assumptions with common understanding.

07 Business Impact

Beta didn't just improve launches — it changed how Trustpilot thinks about go-to-market.



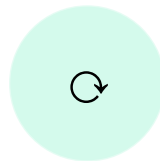
Reduced Launch Risk

Pre-GA validation eliminated surprises, giving product and marketing teams higher confidence at launch.



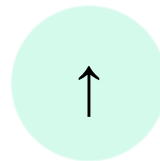
Increased Customer Trust

Customers who co-created the product became invested advocates — trust was earned before the feature shipped.



Supported Churn Reduction

Early activation and deeper engagement during beta translated to measurably stronger retention post-launch.



Beta as GTM Lever

Repositioned beta from a technical QA exercise to a strategic marketing and retention driver.

08

Key Learnings

What the program taught us about product betas as a strategic function.

"Right users > more users"

A smaller cohort of high-fit participants generates far more usable signal than a large, poorly-matched group. Recruitment quality is the program's most important variable.

"Structured comms drive engagement"

Participants who received clear, timely communication were significantly more likely to complete tasks, submit feedback, and stay engaged throughout the beta.

"Closing the loop builds trust"

When participants saw their feedback reflected in product decisions, they became more invested and more vocal advocates at GA.

"Beta users become advocates"

The best outcome isn't a completed product, it's a cohort of customers who feel ownership. Beta participants consistently drove word-of-mouth and expansion.



From Reactive to Repeatable.

Built a beta program from scratch that connected customer insight directly to product, improved GTM readiness, and turned early testers into long-term advocates.



**End-to-End
Ownership**



**Cross-Functional
Alignment**



**Scalable,
Repeatable System**